



Easements, sewer & drainage

The lines on the title you can't see on site — and who has to agree before you build over them.

THREE THINGS THAT RUN THROUGH ORDINARY LOTS

- **Easements on the title** — drainage, access, power. An easement usually means no structures without the beneficiary's consent, and it binds you even if nothing is visible on the ground.
- **Water Corporation sewer mains** — often through the rear or side of the lot, not the street. Building **over or near** one needs Water Corporation approval before the permit stage, and the answer shapes footing design.
- **Council drainage** — pipes and pits in dedicated easements, with the same no-build presumption.

BEFORE THE DESIGN IS SETTLED

- ✓ Pull the **certificate of title** — every easement is listed on it. We can help if you don't have a copy.
- ✓ Check the **service locations** — a Before You Dig (BYDA) search is free and shows sewer, water, power and gas in and around the lot.
- ✓ If the structure lands on or near a sewer: talk to **Water Corporation first**. Their approval (and any concrete-encasement or pier requirements) has to exist before the council will issue the permit.

WHAT WE NEED TO SEE

- ✓ Easements and any sewer within the lot **drawn on the site plan** — or a note that the title is clear.
- ✓ The structure dimensioned clear of them, *or* the written approval that lets it encroach, with footings designed to match.
- ✓ Soak wells kept clear of sewer lines and easements too — they count.

The expensive version of this note: a slab poured over an unprotected sewer junction. It gets found — usually when the neighbour's line blocks — and rectification means cutting the slab. A five-minute title and BYDA check at design time is the whole prevention.

